

AUDIT INVESTIGATION REPORT

Investigation No. INV-00286 | Type: Vendor Risk Assessment

Investigation ID:	INV-00286
Investigation Type:	Vendor Risk Assessment
Status:	IN_PROGRESS
Trigger Source:	Whistleblower hotline report
Lead Investigator:	Edward Whitney (EMP-52703)
Subject Employee:	Amanda Cooper (EMP-16378)
Related Vendor:	XcelPath Networks Group (VND-01610)
Related Transaction:	TXN-EXT-000989
Scope Period:	2022-06-19 to 2023-01-29
Created Date:	2023-05-12
Completed Date:	In Progress
Outcome:	PARTIALLY SUBSTANTIATED

1. AUDIT QUESTION

"Which transactions exhibit patterns consistent with split payment fraud?"

2. BACKGROUND

This investigation was initiated following a whistleblower hotline report relating to activity associated with employee Amanda Cooper (EMP-16378) and vendor XcelPath Networks Group (VND-01610). The investigation scope covers the period 2022-06-19 to 2023-01-29 and was conducted under the authority of the Internal Audit Charter and the Fraud Risk Management Policy.

3. METHODOLOGY

The investigation team reviewed transaction records, approval workflow logs, and supporting documentation associated with Transaction ID TXN-EXT-000989 (amount 19,000.06 GBP, risk score 0.07). Interviews were conducted with relevant personnel and system access logs were reviewed for the scope period.

4. FINDINGS

Finding ID	Severity	Category	Description
FND-000149	LOW	VENDOR RISK	High-risk vendor Acuity Systems Inc has no compliance record on file. Payment of \$15,646 released without compliance clearance.
FND-003672	CRITICAL	POLICY BREACH	Employee submitted Accommodation claim 50% above the authorised policy limit without prior exception approval.
FND-000064	MEDIUM	APPROVAL LIMIT	Payment of \$329,733 approved at Level 2, which has a limit of \$100,000. Transaction exceeded limit by \$14,988.

5. CONCLUSION

The investigation found **PARTIAL** support for the concerns raised. While some irregularities were confirmed, a complete policy breach could not be conclusively established for all elements of the original allegation.

6. ACTIONS TAKEN

- No further action required; control gap addressed through process update.
- Employee access to approval systems suspended pending review.

7. SIGN-OFF

Role	Name	Employee ID	Date
Lead Investigator	Edward Whitney	EMP-52703	2023-05-12